in the country to help Indian cities become cleaner and healthier. Leveraging Indore's position as the cleanest city in the country seven times on a trot, IIM-Indore has partnered with the Indore Municipal Corporation, which facilitates site visits for trainees to see the waste segregation and waste-to-wealth programme. The institute is in the process of incubating start-ups to work in waste management.

IIM-Indore is also working with the Madhya Pradesh Police on a programme to find missing children and prevent children from meeting such a fate. It is also working with the Uttar Pradesh Police and with the state governments of MP and UP on the 'one district one product' scheme to encourage domestic production of various handicrafts, readymade clothes, leather products etc. More recently, it has embarked on a plan to develop colleges in the Northeast. "We have identified certain colleges in Nagaland, and we will handhold them to convert them into model colleges for the rest of the Northeast. We will do this in other remote parts of the country as well," says Prof. Himanshu Rai, director, IIM-Indore.

STUDENTSPEAK



ADITYA SEETHA
PhD Scholar, Management

"Indore was the first IIM to offer a five-year Integrated Program in Management, which I pursued earlier. What sets this course apart is the depth of knowledge emanating from a diversity of subjects taught. In a two-year MBA course, on the other hand, students come from an undergraduate background that has trained them in a single discipline"

ALUMNISPEAK

"IIM Indore has had a transformative impact on me. I had chosen this institute for holistic learning in a variety of courses as well as co-curricular programmes, which help foster leadership. It also taught me to approach challenges with a balanced mindset and to prioritise ethical decisions in every aspect of life"



MANSWINEE THAKUR
Batch of 2023, PGP-Management

When it comes to its international footprint, the institute has tie-ups with 58 universities spread across 23 countries. It has launched a joint executive certificate programme on leadership with the University of Denver, US, and another on sports management with the University of Liverpool, UK. It's also in talks with the University of Glasgow in Scotland and Rutgers University in the US to develop similar programmes. "We plan to expand our international footprint. These [partnerships] will not be limited to student exchange but will cover faculty and non-academic staff exchange too," says Prof. Rai. The institute also plans to enrich its executive education portfolio through capacity-building programmes and consultancies centred around real-life problems. It already runs an executive education certificate programme in Dubai, which has 900 alumni.

Closer home, a joint programme with IIT Indore is already in place while a similar one is being worked out with AIIMS Bhopal. It also has an extension campus offering a weekend MBA programme in Mumbai.

Interestingly, IIM-Indore under its present director has an alternative view on placements. "Our mission is to create, curate and disseminate knowledge that can develop leaders who can solve real-world problems. Placements are a byproduct of this process," says Prof. Rai. "If you have world-class, contextually relevant skills, and if you have induced responsible and ethical behaviour in you, getting a job is not a challenge. I don't want IIM-Indore to become a place where people are in pursuit of a career everyone wants. I want to induce a sense of purpose in them, and then whatever career takes them closer to that purpose is something they should pursue."

Set up in 1996, this premier institute may have been the sixth IIM in the country but was the first to offer the now much sought-after five-year BA/MBA integrated programme in 2011. Well, it is this very kind of thinking out of the box that IIM-Indore wants its students to pursue. ■

INDIAN INSTITUTE OF MANAGEMENT INDORE, INDORE

Established: *1996*
Campus size: *193 acres*
Director: *Prof. Himanshu Rai*
Total students (first and second year): *974*
Share of female students: *32.6%*
Total faculty (permanent and visiting): *146*
Highest annual salary (domestic) earned by a student in 2024: *₹1 crore*
Average annual salary (domestic) earned by students in 2024: *₹25.68 lakh*
Total number of recruiting companies in 2024: *150+*
Total course fee (for two years): *₹20.12 lakh*
Placement record: *100% of students got jobs in 2024 and 2023*